

FUNGI

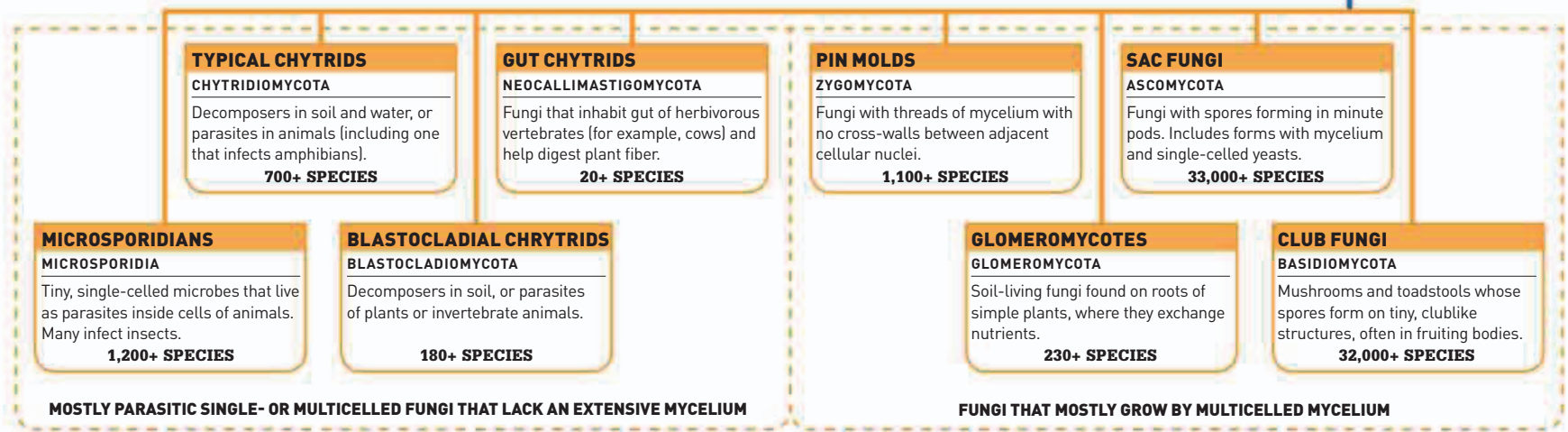
A distinction can be made between simple fungi (the microsporidians and chytrids) and “higher” fungi, which have an extensive mycelium (a network of microscopic filaments). The common feature of chytrids—also called

water molds—is that they produce spores that swim by beating flagella (microscopic hairs). Some kinds of sac or club fungi form lichens: partnerships with certain algae or bacteria to supplement nutrition by photosynthesis.

FUNGI

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70,000+ SPECIES



PLANTS

Plant classification is based largely on their reproduction and life cycle, which alternates between sperm- and egg-producing generations (gametophyte) and spore-producing generations (sporophyte). Gametophytes of simple plants, such as mosses,

need moist habitats to thrive, while in seed plants both generation stages happen inside reproductive shoots (such as cones or flowers), so that the life cycle can succeed in drier conditions.

PLANTS

PLANTAE

290,000+ SPECIES

